

GRAMMAR_19-9-2026

Directions for questions 1 to 15: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- a. When software gets smarter, the first effect is to empower already powerful.
- b. The wider reach and the fantastic power available now to Google and Facebook, which are now in practice the publishers of most of
- c. what appears on the public internet, is one example.
- d. More sinister the power of nations is to spy on their own citizens.
- e. But these advantages cannot last. Soon, they have to be reinforced by the law.

- ☐ a) a, b, and d
- ☐ b) a, c, and d
- ☐ c) b, c, d and e
- ☐ d) b and e

Solution:

Option a is incorrect because when adjective ('powerful' here) is used as a noun, we need to use 'the' before it. Thus, the correction is 'the already powerful'.

Option c has an error because it uses singular verb (is) for the plural subject (the wider reach and the fantastic power).

Option d has a mistake because it positions the verb 'is' wrongly. In this kind of structure, the verb should precede the subject. The correction will be 'More sinister is the power of nations to...'

Thus, the parts that are without mistake are part b and part e.

Thus, the right option is Option D.

Choice (D)

- a. The timing of first arrival of humans in Australia has been studied and debated for decades.
- b. Now, researchers have found evidence that suggests the ancestors of Aboriginal Australians landed in the northern part of Australia at least 65,000 years ago.
- c. The finding, which was published, on Wednesday, in the journal Nature, pushes back the timing of
- d. when people first came to the continent in about 5,000 to 18,000 years.
- e. It also suggests that humans coexisted with colossal Australian animals like giant wombats and wallabies long before the megafauna had gone extinct.

- ☐ a) c and e
- ☐ b) c, d and e
- ☐ c) a, c and d
- ☐ d) All of these

Solution:

Part a is incorrect because an ordinal such as 'first' should be preceded by the definite article. Hence, the correction is 'the first arrival...'.
Part b is incorrect because in the context, we need to use 'that' after 'suggests'.
The correction is '... suggests that the ancestors ...'.
Part d is incorrect because the correct preposition in the context is 'by (about 5,000 to 18,000 years)', not 'in'. Thus, the correction is '... continent by about 5,000 to 18,000 years.'
The parts c and e do not contain any errors.
Thus, the correct option is Option A.

Choice (A)

- a. Science has been central to the rise of the modern world.
- b. The practices of induction, observation, experimentation, theory testing and falsification - and the invaluable products of those practices -
- c. have had all such profound effects on our culture and our ways of thinking.
- d. yet, as much as we have come to rely on it, science, like many other contemporary institutions,
- e. has been drawn into our high politicized culture wars.

- ☐ a) a, b and e
- ☐ b) a, b and d
- ☐ c) a, and c
- ☐ d) a, b and c

Solution:

Option c is with an error because, in the given context, 'all' must be placed after 'have'. Thus, the correction is 'have all had'.

Option e is incorrect because 'highly politicized' is the needed correct usage. An adverb, not an adjective, is needed in the context.

Thus, Options c and e are with errors. Thus, the correct option is Option B.

Choice (B)

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- a. It is the strange persistence of guilt as a psychological force that demarcated the modern life.
- b. If anything, the word *persistence* understates the matter. Guilt has not lingered merely;
- c. it has grown, even metastasized, into an ever more powerful and pervasive element in the life of the contemporary West
- d. even as the rich language formerly used to define it has withered and faded from discourse,
- e. and the means of containing its effects, let alone obtain relief from it, have become more elusive.

- ☐ a) a, c and d
- ☐ b) c and d
- ☐ c) c, d and e
- ☐ d) a, d and e

Solution:

In part a, we need to use simple present (demarcates) because in the latter part, the concept has been expressed using simple present, which is the correct tense in the given context.

In part b, the word 'merely' is wrongly placed. From the context, it should be placed before 'lingered'.

In part e, 'let alone' must be followed by 'obtaining', rather than 'obtain'. We need to maintain parallelism with "containing"

Therefore, part c and part d have no errors.
Thus, the correct option is Option B.

Choice (B)

- a. A few, if any, literary philosophers have had as much influence on American business and politics as Ayn Rand,
- b. especially now that Donald J. Trump occupies the White House.
- c. President Trump named Rand as his favorite writer and The Fountainhead as his favorite novel.
- d. Secretary of State Rex Tillerson has cited Atlas Shrugged as a favorite work, and
- e. the C.I.A director, Mike Pompeo said the book 'really had an impact on me.'

- ☐ a) b, c, d, and e
- ☐ b) a, b, c and d
- ☐ c) b, c, and d
- ☐ d) b, d and e

Solution:

In part a, the use of 'a few' is incorrect; 'few', which means hardly any, is correct in the context.

Part c is incorrect because 'name' (as a verb) should not be followed by 'as'. The correction is 'Trump named Rand his favorite author and the Fountainhead his favorite novel.'

Parts b, d, and e have no errors.

Thus, the right option is Option D.

Choice (D)

- a. Through most of high school, politics remained an abstract concept for me.
- b. In history class, we discussed about Marx' political theory and Plato's Republic, we learned names of kings and queens,
- c. and memorized battle dates, but it was not until I read Memoirs of Hadrian that I understood
- d. that politics are, in fact, about people.
- e. Heavily relied upon historical sources, Yourcenar's Book, a finctional autobiography of a man who ruled the Roman empire until his death in 138 AD, has opened new doors of understanding for me.

- ☐ a) a, b, and c
- ☐ b) a, c and e
- ☐ c) a and c
- ☐ d) All of these

Directions for questions 1 to 15: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- a. An unfortunate side-effect of the otherwise admirable success of Hilary mantel's novel Wolf Hall
- b. and its subsequent blockbuster television adaptations have been a tendency
- c. to make its protagonist, the relatively minor figure Hernry VIII's Chief Minister Thomas Cromwell
- d. to eclipse his hitherto far more famous collateral descendant Oliver Cromwell
- e. and this has sidelined the historical importance of Oliver Cromwell.

- ☐ a) a, b, and c
- ☐ b) a, c and e
- ☐ c) b, c and d
- ☐ d) b, d and e

Solution:

Part b has an error of subject verb agreement because it incorrectly uses plural verb (have) for the singular subject "side-effect"
Part d incorrectly uses 'to eclipse' after 'make' instead of the required bare infinitive (eclipse)
Parts a, c and e have no errors.
Thus, the right option is Option B.

Choice (B)

- a. The government is considering to change the April-March financial year to the calendar year.
- b. This follows a slew of far-reaching steps such as merging the railway budget with the Union Budget,
- c. to advance the date of presentation of the Union Budget, and introduction of goods and service tax.
- d. The change, which is unlikely to happen this year will require the government to advance presentation
- e. of the Union Budget to November-December.

- ☐ a) a, b, and d
- ☐ b) a, b and c
- ☐ c) a, c, and d
- ☐ d) b, d and e

Solution:

Part a contains an error because the verb 'consider' needs an -ing form after it. The correction is 'considering changing'.

Part c contains a parallelism error, which is resulted from using 'to advance'. The correct word is 'advancing'.

Parts b, d and e are without error.

Thus, option D is the right option.

Choice (D)

- a. The debate on the need and desirability of retaining the death penalty has been overshadowed by
- b. much intellectual exertion on the nature of the crime involved, how grave it is, its heinousness and the fatalities it caused.
- c. The time has come to end this debate once and for all by ascending to a moral position
- d. that there shall be no death penalty on the statute book,
- e. in spite of the heinousness of the offence, the circumstances and the number of fatalities involved.

- ☐ a) a, c, and d
- ☐ b) a, b, and e
- ☐ c) b, c, d and e
- ☐ d) All of these

Solution:

Port b and e are incorrect. Part b contains a list of noun phrases after 'nature of', and all of them should be parallel. But the clause 'how grave it is' is not parallel to 'nature of the crime', 'its heinousness' and 'the fatalities it caused'. This can be corrected by using a relevant noun form. Thus, the correction is 'its gravity', which is to be used in the place of the clause.

In part e, 'in spite of' is the wrong preposition in the whole of the context. The word required is 'regardless of'.

The remaining parts are error free.

Thus, the right option is Option A.

Choice (A)

- a. Hyperbole is an ever-present danger up there on the high-low tightrope.
- b. What helps the critic keeping his or her balance is
- c. the acknowledging that it *is* hyperbole, that there is a rhetoric of aesthetic experience
- d. that is always in excess of the actual content.
- e. If you are going to write about Skip James, it would not make sense to strive for a judicious appraisal.

- ☐ a) a, b and c
- ☐ b) a and d
- ☐ c) a, b and d
- ☐ d) a, b and e

Solution:

Part b uses the verb 'keep' followed by 'ing' form, which is incorrect. The correction is '... helps the critic (to) keep...'.
in part c, the correct diction should be 'acknowledgment', not 'acknowledging'.

In part e, the conditional sentence has a wrong combination of tenses. The present tense used in the conditional tense requires either simple present or simple future in the main clause. The correction will be 'it does/will not make...'.
so, Parts b, c and e contain errors.

Thus, Option B is the right option.

Choice (B)

- a. The properties of a granular material depends intimately on how the grains are prepared.
- b. The mechanical strength of a powder that's been gently piled into a heap, for instance,
- c. differs from an identical powder that's been tamped down into a container.
- d. an analogy between a packing of grains and an ensemble of atoms can be drawn.
- e. The volume of the packing is to grains just like energy is to the atoms.

- ☐ a) a, b and e
- ☐ b) a, c, d and e
- ☐ c) a, b and d
- ☐ d) b and d

Solution:

In part a, the verb 'depend' does not agree with the plural subject 'properties'. The correct verb is 'depend'.

In part c, the comparison is incorrect. The mechanical strength of a powder should be compared to 'the mechanical strength' of the identical powder that has been tamped down into a container. Thus, we need to use 'that of' before the noun phrase 'an identical powder...'.
In part e, the analogy (which is drawn in two clauses) requires an 'as' clause to give the sense of the required analogy. Thus, the correction is 'just as energy is to atoms'.

Thus, the parts without error are b and d. Thus, Option D is the right option.

Choice (D)

- a. What do holiday souvenirs have in common with pilgrim badges?
- b. The former are affordable to make and sell; they are eye-catching and showcase the most unique characteristics of their destination through shape, text, colour and images;
- c. importantly, holiday souvenirs are nearly always portable.
- d. Even if we all went to the same place and bought matching mementoes - and the mass produced nature of such 'tourist tat' means that inevitably such items are far from unique-
- e. the feelings we project onto souvenirs are shaped with personal memories.

- ☐ a) a, c and e
- ☐ b) a and c
- ☐ c) c and d
- ☐ d) Only e

Solution:

In b, the expression "most unique" is grammatically incorrect because the meaning of the word unique is already superlative. Therefore, it does not need to be preceded by 'most'. In d, the spelling of the word "mementos" is incorrect. In e, the word "shaped" should be followed by the preposition "by" and not "with". Only a and c are grammatically correct.
Choice (B)

- a. Seventy years ago, on 18 April 1947, British forces set forth the largest non-nuclear explosion in history.
- b. The target was a cliff-bound islet in the North Sea, 50 miles from the German coast: Heligoland.
- c. For generations, this outpost, half the size of Gibraltar had stood as a symbol of Anglo-German conflict.
- d. From the turn of the century until the end of the Second World War, Heligoland has stood as a symbol of Germany's threat to Britain:
- e. the stronghold from where the kaiser and his admirals envisaged entering into battle with the Royal Navy; the fortress which Hitler had built up as a bulwark against Britain.

- ☐ a) c, d and e
- ☐ b) b and c
- ☐ c) a, b and c
- ☐ d) b and e

Solution:

The phrasal verb "set forth", which means to begin a journey, does not make sense. "Set off" is the correct phrasal verb to be used in statement a, in order to make it grammatically correct. To set something off is to make a bomb etc. explode. In c, a comma should be inserted after the word Gibraltar because "half the size of Gibraltar" is a parenthetical clause which conveys additional information regarding the outpost. Therefore, it should be demarcated from the rest of the sentence with commas on either side. In d, the present perfect tense "has stood" is incorrect because the present perfect tense is used to indicate activities completed in the immediate past. As the reference, here, is to a past action, the past perfect tense "had stood" is appropriate. Only b and e are correct in terms of grammar and usage.

Choice (D)

- a. "The London Tradesman", in 1747, described a milliner as a retailer who would furnish everything to the ladies that can contribute to underscore their beauty,
- b. increase their vanity and render them ridiculous.
- c. The milliner worked alongside the mantua-maker, the haberdasher, the draper and the stay-maker to provide elite and middling rank women with the tools of sartorial fashion.
- d. Drapers and haberdashers provided fabrics, notions and ready-made goods; mantua-makers provided a design and construction service for gowns; and the milliner's role bridged the two.
- e. From buttons and trims to ornate concoctions of headwear, this array of retailers provided a vital resource for women who aspired to being à la mode.

- ☐ a) a, b and c
- ☐ b) b, c and d
- ☐ c) c and d
- ☐ d) a, b and e

Solution:

In a, 'underscore' (and not overscore) is apt as it means highlight or draw special attention to. In b, the use of the conjunction "and" is incorrect. The contrast which is evident in the sentence is brought out using "or" and not "and". Therefore, the correction is "increase their vanity or render them ridiculous". In e, the to infinitive cannot be followed by the verb+ing form. The correction here, is ".....who aspired to be a la mode". Only c and d are grammatically consistent. Choice (C)

- a. Magna Carta holds a place of premiere importance in American constitutional history, politics and legal culture.
- b. It is perhaps in the US that Magna Carta enjoys the greatest respect today.
- c. Such is America's reverence for the document that in 2007 the US financier David Rubenstein paid \$21.3 millions to obtain a copy for his nation,
- d. the highest price ever paid for a single sheet of parchment.
- e. Across the US, murals depicting the sealing of Magna Carta at Runnymede decorate the walls of numerous county court houses, where it is displayed as an important symbol of liberty and justice.

- ☐ a) a, b and d
- ☐ b) b, and d
- ☐ c) a, c and d
- ☐ d) b, d and e

Solution:

In a, the word "premiere", which means the first public performance of a movie, play etc., does not make sense. The adjective "premier", meaning most important, is appropriate here. In c, the word "millions" should not be used in the plural. The correction is "\$ 21.3 million". Only b, d and e are grammatically correct.

Choice (D)